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ARTICLE

Colorado's Custody Warning: Misgender Your Child, Lose Your Child





BY PNW STAFF MAY 04, 2026

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It happened fast--almost quietly--but the implications are anything but small.

In Colorado, lawmakers have passed a bill that could reshape the balance of power inside the American home. House Bill 1312 is no longer theoretical--it has been enacted and is scheduled to take effect on October 1, 2026.

It doesn't send police to your door. It doesn't automatically remove children from parents. But it does something more subtle--and in many ways more powerful. It gives the state a new lens through which to judge whether you deserve to raise your own child.

And for many families, that lens could become a breaking point.

Under HB 1312, courts are permitted to consider "misgendering" a child--refusing to use a child's preferred name or pronouns--as a factor in custody decisions. In the abstract, that may sound like just one consideration among many. In reality, anyone familiar with family court knows how decisive these "factors" can become when judges are determining the "best interests of the child."

This is where policy becomes personal.



Tap the item that does not match

Imagine a divided household where a child's gender transition disagreement is no longer just a family matter. It becomes a legal liability.

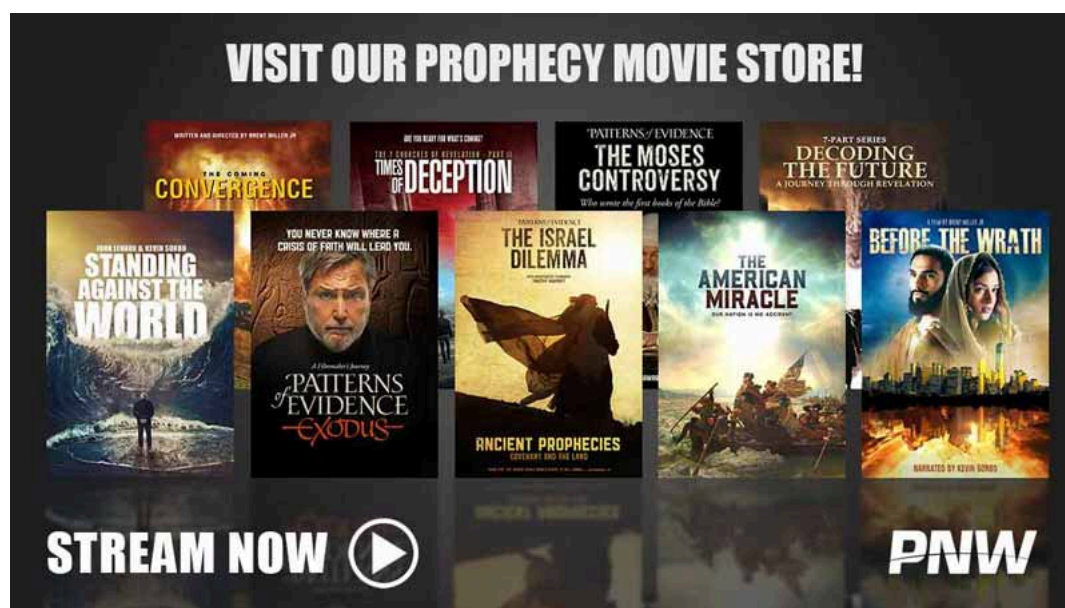
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And in the most painful cases, it could become the reason a parent loses meaningful access to their own child--once the law takes effect this fall.

The legal tension here is not theoretical. The Supreme Court of the United States has repeatedly affirmed that parents have a fundamental right to direct the upbringing of their children, including in *Troxel v. Granville*. That right has limits--but it has never been understood to disappear simply because a parent holds an unpopular view.

HB 1312 raises a difficult question: when the state begins weighing a parent's beliefs against its own preferred framework of identity, who ultimately decides what truth is--and who pays the price when there is disagreement?

For many Christian families, that question is already being answered in real time.



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This is not just a political debate. It is a collision between worldviews. On one side is a rapidly expanding cultural consensus that identity is self-defined and must be affirmed. On the other is a conviction--held by millions of believers--that identity is rooted in something deeper, something given, not chosen.

When those two visions collide, the consequences are no longer confined to social media arguments or academic theory.

They show up in custody rulings. In court orders. In the quiet, devastating moment when a parent realizes that standing by their convictions may come at a cost they never imagined.

That is why this moment demands more than outrage. It demands clarity.

Christians cannot afford to respond with anger alone. The families at the center of this issue are not abstract examples--they are people navigating confusion, fear, and deeply personal struggles. Truth must be spoken, but it must be carried with compassion. Anything less

undermines the very

But compassion does

There is a growing pattern in American law where deeply contested moral questions are being reframed as settled--and where disagreement is increasingly treated not as a difference of belief, but as a form of harm. Once that shift occurs, the role of the state expands quickly. What was once protected speech can become evidence against you. What was once a parental decision can become grounds for intervention.

And that should concern far more than one religious group.

Because once the state establishes that it can weigh your words, your beliefs, and your conscience in determining whether you deserve your children, the precedent does not stay contained. It spreads. It evolves. It adapts to the next issue, the next disagreement, the next line society decides cannot be crossed.

This is how rights erode--not all at once, but step by step, case by case.

So what should Christians do?

Stay engaged. Stay informed. Speak clearly--but wisely. Support families facing these challenges. And perhaps most importantly, prepare.

Prepare for a world where holding to biblical convictions may carry real, tangible consequences--not just socially, but legally. Prepare to walk that road with courage, not fear. And prepare to do so in a way that reflects both truth and grace, even under pressure.

Because the reality unfolding in Colorado is not just about one bill.

It is a signal.

A signal that the boundaries between family, faith, and state authority are shifting. A signal that beliefs once assumed to be protected are now being tested. And a signal that for many parents, the question is no longer theoretical:

What will it cost to stand firm?

And are you ready to pay it?

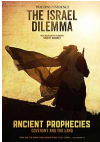


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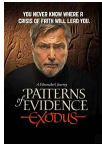
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